

Date: November 19, 2024

From: Medical Center Director, VA Ann Arbor Healthcare System (506/00)

Subj: VAAHS Masking Policy

To: Supervisors

Thru: Chief of Staff, VA Ann Arbor Healthcare System (506/11)

Effective January 1, 2025, VA Ann Arbor Healthcare System is adjusting the masking policy to eliminate mandatory masking for most employees in the inpatient setting. This is a decision that has been carefully made with consideration of COVID-19 and influenza rates throughout our region and throughout the nation.

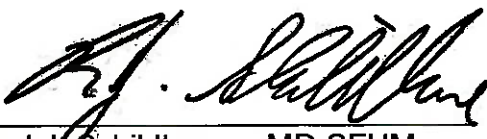
Effective January 1, 2025, universal masking will only be required in the following locations at the Charles S. Kettles VA Medical Center:

- Community Living Center (staff and visitors only)
- Hemodialysis Unit
- Kemp B. Cease Infusion Center
- Emergency Department

Masks will remain available to staff and should be donned if a Veteran or Veteran's representative requests staff do so.

Infection Control will continue to monitor for local outbreaks of respiratory viral infection and will work with individual inpatient units to recommend masking if concerns arise.

This memorandum does not apply to employees who are exempt from seasonal influenza vaccination (as indicated by completion of VA Form 10-9050); these employees must continue to wear a face mask when in any VHA location between December 1st through March 31st, as mandated by VHA Directive 1192.01.


Richard J. Schildhouse, MD SFHM
Chief of Staff

11/20/2024
Date

☒ Approve ☐ Disapprove


Ginny L. Creasman, Pharm.D., FACHE
Medical Center Director

11/20/2024
Date